

Bury St Edmunds Abbey Rotary Club
Monday 12th January @ 18:30. Meet at 18:00
Location: Greene King Beer Cafe



Business Meeting - Minutes

1. **Introduction of Guests** – Andrew Hinchley *Late apology.*
2. **Apologies** – Ron Clare, Gary Clayton, John Connolly, Andy Connacher, Jamie Dalrymple, Ros Luckman, Val Ogden, John Thorpe, Lionel Thurlow, (Dannii Elliott and Kate Thurman as guests)
3. **Late apologies:** Alan Chadwick, Luke Meulepas
4. **President's Points** – Melanie Lesser
 - Approval of last month's minutes. Nigel Barrett proposed and Nigel Bateson seconded.
 - 20th Anniversary Dinner at the Bury St Edmunds Golf Club Sat April 11th. Looking forward to this and celebrate 20yrs.
 - Any items for discussion at the February 2nd Club Council meeting. Any agenda items please submit to DB.
 - Venue proposals - report at next meeting.
6. **President Elect Points** – Max Weatherby – Succession of Club Officers, Improving Club Communication.
 - New President Elect candidate for the 26/27 year is Hayley Coull.
 - Max been working closely with Melanie this year and has put together a number of strategic exercises to improve. 5 will be presented to CC meet and the 1st is improving operational efficiency, e.g. information flow, attending events, and we can improve more. Seems to be excessive email traffic and looking at a single source system in conjunction with Gary. Max will be circulating a video to club member so please view prior to the February meeting.
 - Max attending the District Showcase Day in late January, in Brandon.
7. **Secretary's Report** – Deborah Blumfield – list of 2026/27 meeting dates to be sent with minutes. Replacement of Secretary after 6 years, as is a pivotal role in the club and whilst has grown as the club has grown the principles are the same. I will support the incoming Secretary, please talk to me if you are interested,
8. **Treasurer's Report/Budget** – Phil Peters –
 - Club account £3844 but RIGB&I for subs due to come out, so we have a nice balance.
 - Fund Raising account £4933 contains some Burns Night income. Funds available for distribution are £2030.
 - All St Eds Dinner beneficiaries paid. Village Water £250, £393 to Young People Afloat, Ice creams £23.Nic H thanked Phil for distributing the funds so promptly.
9. **Team Chairs' Reports** –
 - Business Liaison** – Gary Clayton – apologies received, Max W has Gary's report – *I have been working closely with Max on the database for the club and will be able to reveal more about that in the February meeting. As regards Business liaison I have made progress on the event management in readiness for those committees preparing for activities in 2026.*
 - Classic Car Show** – Phil Peters - organisation starting apace and PS already got 300 cars from exhibitors booked in. PP will see Alan C as a few enquiries already for stands. Meeting booked at Culford in Feb. 12th July is a must attend day. Nic Hardy doing sponsorship again, last year had 5 new sponsors and needs some help visiting existing sponsors and seeking new for 3 years term. There is space for 3-4 people to help source more. Couple of members offered to help.

Community Service - Alan Brown - email received from Brave Futures re the Snow Dash thanking us for the support. 300 runners and raised >£7000, Supported by survivors and great feedback.

Fellowship/Rotary Links— Alan Chadwick - apologies received

Foundation and Environment – Andrew Winearls - nothing to report

Fundraising — Nic Hardy - Auction 2026 - due to be launched and needs 3 volunteers - Team Janet, Glyn and Trish to help. Have a template that works and Nic will help. Lots needed and bid to go on the Jumblebee site. The community service team have worked very closely with the charities and an opportunity to connect, and they earn from the proceeds by supplying lots. We need to supply lots of lots and business liaison can get involved, etc everyone needs to be involved please, be resourceful. Janet says she and Glyn and Trish will do their best to help raise the lots. Going live on 19th March.

Health & Safety - Nigel Barrett - started the Car show H&S documents and Richard has offered to help too. Burns Night done.

International – Clyde Palmer –

- Ron does LWC - no report.
- The Lifeline Hospital in India - on last campaign managed in a month 303 eye surgeries, over 1000 spectacles, 200 hearing aids, plastic surgery, dental clinics etc plus more. They give Relief, Dignity and a 2nd chance to many people.
- The Rotary Plastics recycling programme. factory going into production with a 250tonnes of raw plastic is being repurposed, e.g. make tiles, planks and posts for gardening. This is taking plastics out of the ocean.

Kevelaer visit- Alan Chadwick - apologies received with a message: the Kevelaer club will be coming over to us in late. July or early August - awaiting to hear which dates suit them best

Membership & Welfare - Jo Beresford / Abbi Thorpe

Stephanie Shedd was due to join us but too busy so will be a Friend of Rotary.

Update of teams list: Abbi asked if any changes of teams, please let her know.

Outreach Officer /Club Liaison— Peter Summers – looks after the Wolsey Challenge & Tiel

- Scatter night will be taken over by Janet and Trish.
- We are due to be in Tiel later this year, dates TBA. They are holding their superb Chefs Dinner, Thursday May 28th, Tickets are £110 plus your travel and accommodation costs. Please see PS.

PR – Melanie Lesser – PR/Press albums here to view.

Programme & Social — Ruth Pusterla - No changes to the social programme.

- Burns Night is sold out.
- Phil's Quiz night on 23rd February at No 5 Angel Hill. Social with a little bit of FR, 10 teams of 4 at £15/head. General knowledge for BHF. Need to beat Val's team!!!
- Also trying to organise a Ghost Tour and a Food and Drink tour,

Social media – Stuart Hughes -

Website - Wendie Summers –

Looks after the FB page also and we are now followed by the Rotary RIBI news Editor! Plus 850 other followers. Website: Glyn now an administrator and looking to move it forward and to dovetail with internal communications and Max's plans. The website is a great window for the club. The Burns Night has sold out especially through the website.

Youth Service, Interact & Safeguarding – Wendie Summers –

Young Photographer – received some lovely entries and Jamie plus 2 ladies from the Bury Photographic Society have reviewed including entries from our Interact Club.

RYLA - looking for candidates, dates to be confirmed. Would like a couple of sponsored corporate candidates plus one the Club can sponsor. The Theatre Royal staff have really benefitted and WS will ask them again for a candidate.

10. AOB

- Swimathon – Clyde Palmer - 8th March 12:00-16:00, team of 4 swim in relays for 40 minutes at own pace. Choose a charity to support, no entry fee, organised by the mother club.
- Nic H: has a meeting on 19 January with Brave Futures for new opportunities and they are a headline charity for the car show. See Nic if wish to join him.
- Martin Glenn: - Friends of Rotary - often past members, or members of other clubs. They support us in social functions, volunteer to help e.g. fundraising, car show, the St Eds Dinner etc. Would like to give them name badges and run a social to meet them and get to know better. If you are organising events, Glyn holds the list. Club approved to support financially.
- Jill B: - one of Jills neighbours is a SARS Dr and sent a Christmas card and very grateful for our contribution.
- Asked the Club Council to note – Rotary needs to be fun and not too business orientated, not have loads of admin, remember it's fun. PS reiterated to that CC should come back to Club to vote of issues.
- Phil P: 28th January there is a District council meeting via Zoom - you have all been invited.
- Nigel Barrett - Couple of months ago we had 5 items in 1080 news and in December it was not published due to lack of stories, we should have more next month!!
- Sergeant at Arms – Chris R fleeced us for various actions and verbal misdemeanours
- BARC the Rotary Cat keeper for next month! Hayley is looking after BARC

11. Date & Time of Next Meeting

Monday 10th February 2026 @ 18:30